05. Deep Blue

Nova Cup · upgrade blueprint · src/kart/tracks/deep.ts

Where it is now

2.8 km underwater with low gravity: station dome, wreck or ribs, glass chute, broken-tube jump, sunken city or maintenance tube.

What is wrong

Low gravity is the only difference; otherwise it is a tube road.

Core mechanic

Water physics. Currents push you sideways, bubble vents launch you upwards, and you can steer freely while airborne. Open-water sections where the road ends and you swim-glide between platforms.

Signature moments

- The whirlpool: ride round its rim or cut through the middle and get spun out at speed.
- Breaks in the glass tubes: leave the tube, swim-glide across open water and rejoin further on.
- A bubble-vent field that launches you up to a high short cut.

Layout changes

- Keep the dome and the wreck.
- Add the whirlpool basin and two open-water crossings.
- Put bubble vents on the sunken-city route.

Lap changes

- Lap 2: leaks flood sections of the tubes (slower, slippery).
- Last lap: the currents reverse direction.

Engine work needed

- Force zones: currents, vents, the whirlpool.
- Free steering in the air/water (an underwater glide).
- Time-varying force zones (reversal).

Rivals

- Rivals steer with currents and choose rim or centre on the whirlpool.

Done when

- Laps of 50-60 s for a good driver; all 3-lap test races finish with no errors.
- Rivals use every route and the core mechanic, with no more than 2 rival falls per race.
- The core mechanic is in play for at least half the lap, not just one set piece.
- A blind test: a screenshot or a 10-second clip of this track could not be mistaken for any other track.
- Item rows are never on the start line; nothing solid blocks a road by accident.